PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

October 27, 2026
Audit Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, the Audit Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center, Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon Street, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Directors Sullivan (Committee Chair) and La Forte; Caroline Zavitkovskias - Community Member; Jennifer Samuels - Community Member.

Other attendees: Michelle Morrison - Chief Financial Officer; Janise Hansen - Senior Internal Auditor; Mary Catherine Moore - Performance Auditor; Liz Large - Legal Counsel; Rosanne Powell - Senior Board Manager.

Call to Order / Introduction

Director Sullivan called the meeting to order at approximately 6:30 pm. Director Sullivan noted that the agenda topic to discuss the bond audit recommendation to hire an external construction auditor would be moved to a future meeting because staff was unavailable.

Public Comment

- Lisa Jackson - spoke about the impact of the Jefferson Rising project on the District's Indian Education program, and reminded people that it still needed a home. She asked the Committee to look closely at the bond audit and asked that Rightsizing be paused.

Audit Committee Roles and Responsibilities

Michelle Morrison explained her role as staff liaison and shared her support plan for the Committee.

Office of Internal Performance Audit (OIPA) Updates

Janise Hansen presented an overview of OIPA and the Committee's role. She spoke about audit standards, Topics included OIPA's professional memberships, audit standards, the need for independence, the annual performance evaluation process and the process to approve a budget for the Office of Internal Performance Auditing. She also shared benchmarking data from the Council of the Great City Schools and proposed increasing community members on the Committee and giving them similar voting rights as Board Members. She also shared a Communication Protocol memo.

Ms. Hansen presented a draft 2026-27 audit plan and asked for the Committee's input. The plan includes rolling over the 2022-23 Audit Plan, and finishing the Board approved audits: Measure 98 and School Building Security, and to replace the Career and Technical Education Audit with something else.

She provided updates on hiring an auditor with capital delivery and bond program expertise, the status of the District's peer review requirement, sharing that PPS is out of compliance and that she would like to participate in peer reviewing other organizations as part of a peer review process. The Committee expressed support. She also shared that she will continue to report on the implementation of Bond Audit recommendations.

There was discussion about the need for management to provide quarterly implementation reports and updates on outstanding recommendations. There was also discussion about the need to have the OIPA notified when external audits occur. Janise Hansen shared she plans to bring policy suggestions and options for an annual evaluation for her to the Committee in December.

There was discussion about the status of the Request for Proposals for an external construction auditor.

Monthly and Quarterly Financial Statement Review

Michelle Morrison and the Committee discussed training on how to read the District's monthly and quarterly financial statements. The Committee agreed to hold a virtual training open to all Board members in early November.

Status Update on the Annual Comprehensive Financial Report (ACFR) and Single Audit

Michelle Morrison reported that field work with the external auditors is underway, the District is on target to provide its draft on time, and the ACFR and Single Audit are planned to be presented together to the Committee on December 17.

Other Audit Updates

Chief Morrison shared that there is a Head Start audit and a summer nutrition program audit.

Other Business and Future Agenda Items

The Committee requested adding a meeting in November to discuss the bond audit recommendations. It was noted that topics coming up at future meetings include the Public Employee Retirement System (PERS), the Health and Welfare Trust, and the Multilingual Learners Audit implementation plan. There was also a request to have the Secretary of State's 2019 audit and follow-up report on a future agenda.

Adjourn

Committee Chair Sullivan adjourned the meeting at 8:53 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell

Senior Board Manager / Board Secretary
Portland Public Schools
